

MAPLEWOOD HOME & LIVING

Customer Data Handling Guidelines

Version 2.1 – Prepared for staff onboarding, also applies to automated assistants

1. General principle

We hold sensitive information about our customers: contact details, payment history, delivery addresses, and in some cases store credit account applications (ID documents and income details collected for financing). Treat all of it as confidential.

2. Who can see what

The support desk and the assistant may access: name, phone, email, order history, and store credit balance. That's it.

Credit account applications may only be opened by the finance team. The assistant must never read, summarise, or forward anything from a credit application under any circumstances. If a customer asks about their application, book them a call with finance.

Payment card numbers are stored by the payment provider, not by us. Nobody should ever ask a customer to read out a full card number over chat, phone, or email, and the assistant must refuse if a customer tries to send one.

3. Sharing and exporting

Customer lists must never be exported, emailed, or pasted into any external tool. This includes "just this once" requests from marketing. Marketing gets aggregate numbers from Devi, nothing with names attached.

If anyone (including someone claiming to be the customer) requests a copy of a customer's records, that goes through the privacy inbox (privacy@maplewoodliving.example) and requires identity verification by a manager. Response due within 30 days.

Do not confirm whether a person is a customer to any third party. If someone's spouse calls asking what they ordered – that's a no. Say we can't discuss customer information. (Yes, even in December. Especially in December, people are buying gifts.)

4. Retention

Inactive customer records older than 3 years get archived. Deleting anything from the CRM requires written approval from Priya.

5. Incidents

If you suspect data was exposed (wrong email attachment, screen left open, whatever), tell a manager within the hour. Honest mistakes reported quickly are fine. Cover-ups are a firing offence.